

RAJAT KULSHRESHTHA

Engineering Manager

Bengaluru, India (open to relocate to Stockholm) | +91 9207179678 | rajatk171993@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/rajat-kulshreshtha-a598434b

SUMMARY

Engineering Manager with 11+ years at PayPal running high-scale, consumer- and merchant-facing product platforms. Directly led **10+ engineers** (30+ across the product) and **cross-geo, distributed teams** of frontend, backend, mobile and QA engineers at **99.995% availability with zero P0/P1s**. Hands-on in Java, Spring Boot and microservices. Led adoption of **AI-assisted, agentic engineering** (Claude) and shipped **AI-enabled tools**; Received **PayPal Trailblazer Award** as Innovation Architect, 2025. Partners with Product Managers and builds high-performing teams.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership: Engineering management, people management and coaching, hiring, performance management, cross-geo (distributed) team leadership, OKRs, stakeholder and product partnership, leading through change and ambiguity.

Engineering: System architecture, microservices, REST and GraphQL APIs, security, observability and alerting, operational ownership, scalability, legacy modernisation, ROI-driven tech decisions, AI-assisted and agentic engineering.

Technology: Java, Spring Boot, Git, Jenkins, Claude, Datadog, Splunk, OpenAPI/Swagger, SQL, Kafka, Docker,

EXPERIENCE

PayPal India Private Limited, Bengaluru, India

Jul 2015 – Sep 2026

Manager, Software Development (Engineering Manager), Activity Services

Jul 2022 – Sep 2026

- **Directly managed 10+ engineers** (4+ years) and led 30+ in a full-stack product model, owning transaction listing, search and details APIs behind in-app (**32%+ engagement**) and email (**27%+ engagement**) experiences; delivered **90+ product, 25+ strategic, 35+ security** and 10+ tech-excellence initiatives.
- **Cross-geo product delivery:** led 13 engineers across frontend, backend, mobile and QA, with 6 domain teams across AMER, EMEA and APAC, to build **Rewards in Activity feed** of the PayPal Oslo app (**22%+ engagement**): 8+ reward variations, 10+ use cases, 4M+ records/day, 200M+ backfilled; unified 3/2 Cashback and Credit transactions in feed.
- **AI-assisted engineering practices:** led team AI adoption, avoiding duplicate AI use cases; built a shared context layer ("LLM Wiki": repo conventions, coding standards, architecture rules, domain docs) so AI agents act as domain experts.
- **Agentic SDLC workflow (built with Claude):** plugins for architecture and planning, feature development and PR review from Jira requirements, built bottom-up from single-purpose agents; **30%+ faster requirements-to-review**, lets developers new to our systems contribute, now being tested on system bugs.
- **AI-enabled colleague-facing tools:** domain-support Slack bot (**60% less developer time, 70% shorter wait** for first response from other teams, incl. cross-geo); Datadog and Splunk alert triage that analyses deviations against code, rollouts and downstream dependencies; Jira agent turning sprint-planning documents into stories (**40%+ less Jira effort**).
- **AI-assisted modernisation:** moved 7 legacy APIs (15+ years old, 30M+ daily merchant queries) to Java using AI, **zero P0/P1 impact**; cut 99.99% failures, 60M insecure retrievals/day & 90% of Op-ex; used AI in SDLC with **50% productivity uplift**.
- **Operations and performance:** sustained **99.995% availability** with alerting and triage processes; re-architected a Tier-1 system for **8x throughput, USD 300K+/year saved, 450+ fewer VMs, 50% lower latency and CPU**; distributed caching removed 2.75B outbound calls/day, freeing 1k+ VMs across PayPal.
- Nominated by Senior Director+ leadership to lead a cross-geo 7+ engineer team (backend, web, app) on PayPal's top-priority **anti-spam platform**; delivered **a month ahead**.
- **Product and executive partnership:** instituted Product–Program–Engineering syncs; led 70%+ of inbound intake, accelerating alignment 50%+; prioritised 120+ product requests by ROI; aligned architects on 8 tech initiatives; weekly executive updates; raised sprint throughput 25%+ and cleared a 100+ ticket backlog (winning back 10+ merchants).
- **Grew the team:** hired 10, promoted 3; monthly 1:1s; 5 interns, all secured PPOs; **Glint performance score 91/100**, 14 points above PayPal, highest in the Consumer org; built AI-based Slack bot for weekly kudos and growth summaries.

Member of Technical Staff 1, Activity Services

Mar 2022 – Jun 2022

- Led migration of "Actions in Activities" to eventual consistency (**70% lower latency, USD 480K/year saved**); added GraphQL detail-page loading; rebuilt "Did you mean" search on existing capabilities after an Elastic Search infra ROI review (**USD 220K/year saved**).

Software Engineer 3, Activity Services

Feb 2020 – Mar 2022

- Led **15+ engineers** (1.5 years) to **decommission 4 legacy services** (15+ years old): USD 700K/year saved, 100K+ lines of code removed, 25x+ faster in 7 product searches.
- Led 8 engineers on **X-Geo enablement** (data migration for millions of customers, China audit compliance, PayPal products launched in China); cut Search API latency **20x**.

Software Engineer 1 and 2, Activity Services

Jul 2015 – Feb 2020

- Led 5 engineers building **Enterprise Audit** for large merchants in 10+ economies; led a **security upgrade** (client authentication, encryption); built self-serve platform architecture (**3x faster time to market**) and a CI jobs dashboard (10K+ developer hours saved); migrated 2 customer-facing APIs (300M+ daily requests), **cutting deployment time 97.5%**.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS AND AWARDS

Indian Institute of Technology Guwahati, India

2011 – 2015

B.Tech, Electronics and Electrical Engineering, Minor in CS; GPA 8.93/10; Institute Silver Medal (EEE, 2015).

Professional Diploma in Coaching and Mentoring, Kingstown College, Ireland (Distinction, 81/100) **Nov 2024 – Jun 2025**

PayPal Manager Benchmark Certification (2024). **English:** IELTS 7.5/9 (CEFR C1).

Awards: PayPal Trailblazer Award, Innovation Architect (2025); Star of the Month (2021); Heroes (2020); 20+ Props! and 12 Spot Rewards; 1st in PayPal Bangalore SecForce security championship (2019).

Additional material: drive.google.com/drive/folders/13Bf0HafvCIkevoNJ00SZOg74DJxv4I3P